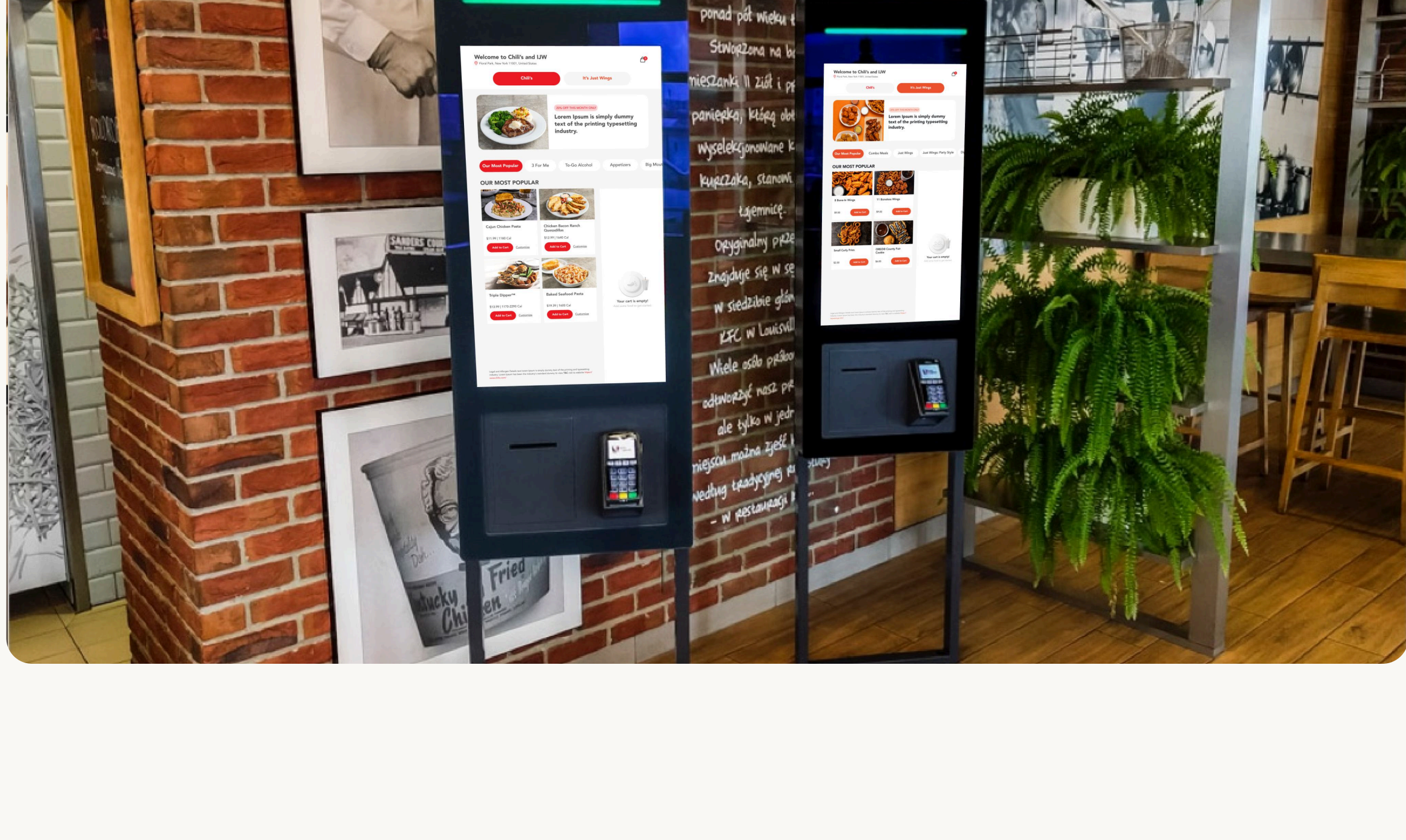


Chili's & It's Just Wings

Self-Service Food Ordering Kiosk (MVP)

DESIGNED BY
Mirajgave Mangesh
Senior UX Designer



Project Details

TIMELINE
28 Jul 2022 – 1 Oct 2022

PROJECT TYPE
MVP (Minimum Viable Product)

PLATFORM
32-inch Restaurant Self-Service Kiosk

Prototype:
<https://www.figma.com/proto/4aeiaXa1c...>

Project Overview

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Project Overview

Chili's Grill & Bar is one of the world's leading casual dining restaurant chains, serving American and Tex-Mex cuisine across more than **1,600 locations** globally.

To improve guest experience and reduce dependence on staff during peak hours, Chili's explored a self-service ordering kiosk that would allow guests to independently browse menus, customize items, and complete purchases.

As part of the MVP initiative, the business wanted to validate whether customers would successfully adopt a kiosk-based ordering experience while supporting orders from both Chili's and It's Just Wings through a single checkout process.

My Role

Requirement gathering Stakeholder collaboration
Competitive analysis User research UX strategy
User flows High-fidelity UI Design Prototyping

Design Process

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UX Process

To ensure business and user needs remained aligned throughout the project, I followed a UX process.



Understand

Understand stakeholder goals, technical limitations, and business objectives.



Research

Conducted desk research, Review industry trends and customer expectations



Analyze

Identify key user behaviors, pain points, and opportunities.



Design

Create workflows, brand guidelines and visual designs.



Prototype

Build interactive prototypes to validate workflows.



Test & Iterate

Conduct usability testing and refine the experience.



Design Approach

Because this project had a short timeline and was being developed as an MVP, the focus was on validating critical assumptions rather than building every possible feature. The objective was to identify the simplest experience that could successfully help users browse menus, customize products, complete payment, and receive order confirmation without staff assistance.

Understand

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Requirement Understanding

At this stage, I worked to understand the project scope, evaluate the brand guidelines that needed to be followed, and determine which requirements were out of scope.

Scope of the Project

- Multi-Brand Menu Ordering**
Enable ordering from Chili's Limited Menu (Ghost Kitchen Tier) and IJW Limited Menu (excluding smoked wings), including the ability to purchase from multiple brands in a single transaction.
- Guest Information Collection**
Collect essential guest details such as First Name, Last Name, Phone Number, SMS consent preference, and Location ID during the ordering process.
- Promotions & Discounts**
Allow guests to apply coupon codes during checkout to receive eligible discounts on their orders.
- Secure Checkout & Payments**
Provide a secure payment experience that supports successful order completion and transaction processing.
- POS & KDS Integration**
Ensure accurate PLU and modifier capture with seamless communication of order details to POS and Kitchen Display System (KDS) platforms.
- Order Confirmation Notifications**
Send order confirmation receipts and notifications via SMS and/or email after successful checkout.
- Success Criteria**
Users complete orders without assistance. Multi-brand ordering works seamlessly. Order details are accurately transmitted to downstream systems. Guests receive confirmation notifications after checkout.

Out Of Scope

- Loyalty Program**
Loyalty program integration, user accounts, and saved favorites were excluded from MVP.
- Personalization**
Order history, personalized recommendations, and multi-language support were deferred.
- Success Criteria**
Users complete orders without assistance. Multi-brand ordering works seamlessly. Checkout completion rates remain high.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

"How might we design a self-service kiosk that allows guests to place accurate orders independently, complete payment securely, and receive confirmation with minimal staff intervention?"

Research

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Desk Research

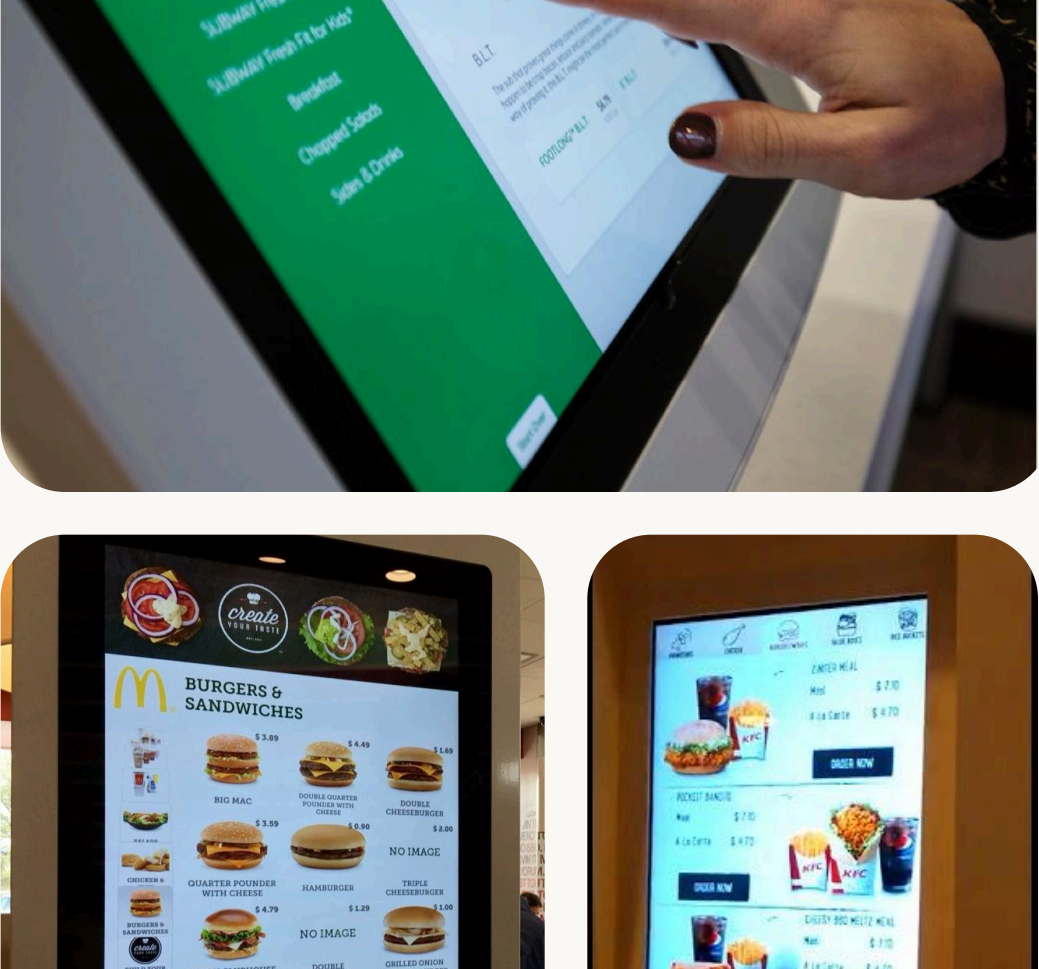
Due to project timelines and business constraints, direct access to restaurant guests was limited. To understand user expectations and industry best practices, I conducted extensive desk research using publicly available reports, articles, customer reviews, restaurant ordering studies, and self-service kiosk research.

Key Findings

- Customers value speed and convenience over human interaction during ordering.
- Users want full control over menu exploration and customization without feeling rushed.
- Customers are more likely to add extra items when recommendations are visually presented.
- Users expect pricing transparency throughout the ordering journey.

DESIGN OPPORTUNITIES

- Enable quick menu discovery
- Simplify item customization
- Keep pricing visible at every step



Kiosk software from various businesses, highlighting the diversity of user interfaces.

User Persona

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Sarah Mitchell

Marketing Executive, 32
Dallas, Texas

"I want to order lunch quickly without standing in line or repeating my order."

ABOUT SARAH

Sarah visits restaurants during her lunch breaks and after work. She values convenience and prefers digital experiences that help her complete tasks quickly.

She does not want to wait in line and expects ordering systems to be simple, intuitive, and efficient.

DEMOGRAPHICS

Age 32
Occupation Marketing Executive
Marital Status Married
Education Bachelor's Degree
Location Dallas, Texas

Goals

- Complete ordering quickly
- Skip waiting lines
- Easily customize meals
- Pay securely

Frustrations

- Long queues
- Slow ordering processes
- Confusing menus
- Too many checkout steps

Motivations

- Speed
- Convenience
- Accurate orders
- Contactless transactions

BEHAVIORS

- Orders restaurant food 2-3 times per week
- Uses digital payment methods regularly
- Checks menu prices before ordering
- Frequently customizes meals
- Prefers self-service over counter ordering

NEEDS & EXPECTATIONS

- Large and easy-to-read menu information
- Visible running total while ordering
- Quick customization options
- Minimal checkout steps
- Secure payment experience

PERSONALITY TRAITS

Tech-Savvy 95%
Organized 90%
Efficiency-Focused 92%
Detail-Oriented 80%

DIGITAL COMFORT LEVEL

Mobile Apps 5 stars
Contactless Payments 4 stars
Online Food Ordering 4.5 stars

PREFERRED BRANDS

Chili's Starbucks McDonald's

User Journey

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USER SCENARIO

"Sarah arrives at Chili's during her lunch break. The ordering counter has a queue, so she decides to use the self-service kiosk to place her order."

JOURNEY STAGE	1 Discover	2 Explore Menu	3 Customize Order	4 Checkout	5 Confirmation
USER ACTIONS	- Notifies queue at ordering counter - Spots self-service kiosk - Approaches kiosk	- Selects Chili's or It's Just Wings - Browses menu categories - Compares meal options - Opens product details	- Selects product - Adds modifiers and extras - Reviews selections - Adds item to cart	- Reviews cart - Applies coupon - Enters contact information - Completes payment	- Receives SMS receipt - Waits for food preparation - Order routed to kitchen
THINKING	"This looks faster than waiting in line."	"What should I order today?"	"Can I customize this the way I want?"	"I hope checkout is quick and secure."	"Great, my order is confirmed."
PAIN POINTS	Uncsure of Kiosk UX Sarah is unsure whether the kiosk is easy to use.	Menu Overload Too many menu choices at once.	Over-Complexity Complex customization flow.	Checkout Length Lengthy checkout process delays the user.	Status Blindness Uncertainty about real-time order status.
OPPORTUNITIES	Visual Attraction Use attractive, looping visuals to draw users over.	Clean Navigation Category-based, fluid side navigation structure.	Simple Modifiers Simplified flow using steps & clean visual hierarchy.	Minimalist Fields Minimize required user form fields.	Feedback Screens Clear confirmation screen and SMS receipt.

Brand Guidelines

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BRAND IDENTITY

Chili's Colors

Primary Red #E81C24

Off White #F8F5F2

Green Accent #5D9732

Dark Gray #4A4A4A

It's Just Wings Colors

Primary Orange #E0512E

Light Gray #F2F2F2

Dark Text #212529

Neutral Gray #808080

TYPOGRAPHY

H1 - 42px
Font Family: Avenir LT Std

H2 - 32px
Primary Screen Headers

H3 - 28px
Section & Category Titles

H4 - 24px
Product Cards & Cart Row Bold

H5 - 18px
Subtitle - 18px

Body - 16px
Detailed Explanations & Descriptions

CHILI'S TACO COMBOS

Choose Your Flavor Profile

Drinks & Desserts

Smoked Bone-In Wings

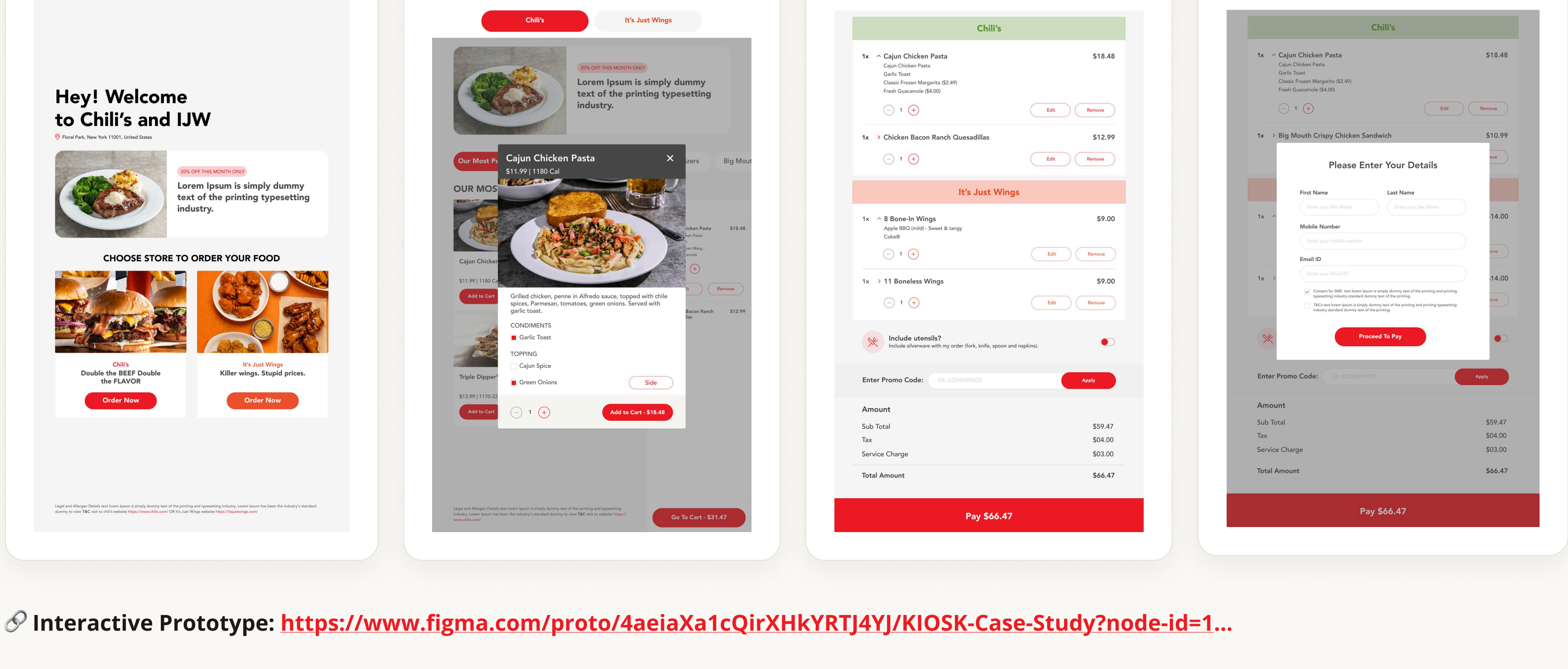
Extra Ranch Dipping Sauce

Fresh hand-breaded chicken wings tossed in spicy Buffalo sauce.

Design Solution & Prototype

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KEY KIOSK SCREENS



Interactive Prototype: <https://www.figma.com/proto/4aeiaXa1cQirXHkYRTJ4Y/KIOSK-Case-Study?node-id=1...>

Challenges & Learnings

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Key challenges faced and lessons learned.

Large Screen, Low Resolution

The kiosk hardware utilized a 32-inch touchscreen with lower resolution than modern tablets and mobile devices.

Solution: Increased button sizes, improved spacing, simplified layouts, and enhanced visual hierarchy.

Technical Constraints

The kiosk needed to integrate with existing Payment, POS, and Kitchen Display Systems.

Solution: Close collaboration with engineers ensured technical feasibility without compromising critical user experiences.

Multi-Brand Ordering

Supporting Chili's and It's Just Wings inside a single experience introduced navigation and cart complexity.

Solution: Designed a unified checkout experience while preserving individual brand identities.

Conclusion

This MVP project demonstrated how a focused, user-centered approach can help validate new digital ordering experiences. By combining lean research, iterative design, and close collaboration with stakeholders, I created a self-service kiosk that simplified ordering for guests while supporting Chili's operational goals and future digital transformation initiatives.

SENIOR UX DESIGNER

Mirajgave Mangesh
Senior UX Designer

KEY LEARNINGS

- Designing for kiosks was fundamentally different from designing for mobile applications.
- Physical screen placement significantly influences interaction design decisions.
- MVP design requires prioritizing critical user needs over feature completeness.
- Early collaboration with stakeholders and developers reduces implementation risks.